

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

EBENEZER 87.87.87.87

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 12/8 time. It consists of four systems of music, each with a vocal line and three-part harmony (soprano, alto, and tenor) indicated by chord diagrams and fingerings. The key signature has one flat (Bb). The lyrics are arranged in three stanzas, with the first two stanzas having three parts and the third stanza having two parts. The final system ends with a double bar line.

System 1:

Chords: Dm (231), A (21), Bb (3211), A (21), Dm (231), F (21), C (3), Dm (231), A7 (1), Dm (231).

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,
2 New oc - ca-sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un-couth;
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros-per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

System 2:

Chords: Dm (231), A (21), Bb (3211), A (21), Dm (231), F (21), C (3), Dm (231), A7 (1), Dm (231).

in the strife of truth with false-hood, for the good or e - vil side;
they must up-ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.
though her por-tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

System 3:

Chords: F (21), C (3), Dm (231), A (21), Dm (231), C (3), Dm (231), C (3), F (21).

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch-ed crust,
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp-fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

System 4:

Chords: Dm (231), A (21), Bb (3211), A (21), Dm (231), F (21), C (3), Dm (231), A7 (1), Dm (231).

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp-'rous to be just;
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de-nied.